

Ireland

Ratio: 1:2 **Adopted:** January 21, 1919 **Usage:** National and Civil



Europe



After centuries of British rule, **Ireland** was split in 1921, becoming the Free State (The Republic of Ireland) and the northern Six Counties.

The Irish flag is modeled on that of the French *Tricolore*. It was first flown by nationalists during their struggle for freedom from Britain in 1848, a year of Europe-wide revolution. However, it was not until the Easter Rising of 1916 that it came to be regarded as the national flag. It was officially confirmed in 1919 and was written into the Constitution in 1937. The green coloring on the flag

represents the Catholic majority; orange is for the Protestant minority (originally supporters of William of Orange) and white is for peace between the two faiths.

THE PRESIDENT'S STANDARD

The flag of the President was introduced in 1945 and is based on the ancient "Green Flag," a traditional symbol of Irish nationalism.

THE PRESIDENT'S STANDARD

The harp is said to be the harp of Brian Boru, an 11th century ruler



The flag is similar to the quartering for Ireland on the Royal Arms of the United Kingdom